

portant challenge faced by the solar industry in India is lack of money to invest. Piyush Goyal, power minister of the country said, "India's solar industry doesn't have enough capital to support the amount of manufacturing we are expecting from it. Hence we have requested Commerce and Finance ministries to review the proposal of imposing an anti-dumping duty on solar equipment. We expect to grow solar industry in India in the future. So, this is going to be a short-term review."

Power at a better price

The ultra mega power projects of 1000MW for solar, led by the government, have decreased the price of the solar power to ₹ 6.5 or ₹ 7 per unit in the last three years. An MNRE officer clarified that, "The bidding cost was slashed down to ₹ 8-10 per unit from ₹ 17 per unit after endless efforts of

NVNVN." Sandip says, "To further decrease the power rates, we will have to bring down the tariffs on solar electronics products, increase the R&D efficiency and bring better quality products in market."

The Directorate General of Anti-Dumping (DGAD) has urged anti-dumping tariffs of up to US\$ 0.48 per watt of solar cells coming from the USA and US\$ 0.81 per watt from China. Meanwhile, it recommends duties of up to US\$ 0.62 per watt and US\$ 0.59 per watt for solar cells from Malaysia and Taiwan, respectively. DGAD has also recommended to the Finance Ministry that, India should impose dumping duty on international solar panels imported from the USA, Taiwan, China and Malaysia. Meanwhile, Tata Power Solar insists that the Finance Ministry should approve the same as soon as possible so as to save India's domestic solar manufacturing

sector from collapsing without the anti-dumping tariffs. Sandip feels that anti-dumping of the solar electronics might work, but would be effective only for a short term to sustain the price of the products, if the quality is not improved.

KPMG reports that an innovative lease model can further improve the market attractiveness for consumers by avoiding high upfront costs and reducing monthly power bills. They explain this with an example where a high-end residential consumer can install a 1kW solar PV system and reduce the marginal power consumption with a monthly EMI payment of around ₹ 2000 (without any down payment) for five years and avoid an average discounted monthly payment of around ₹ 1200 over the lifetime (25 years) of the grid. ●

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